post mark on it. And some kind fellow has written on it in a lawyer-like hand "Erzerum, Armenia" and so it has found its way here. You ought to have written on it "pr Pininsular and Oriental steamers" and then it would have come all right. My friends the Greeks tell me that these steamers start from Southampton and I observe my dear Fathers letter has written on it "Via Southampton." There is also another company now sending their boats from England to Const[le] and Trebizonde but these start from Liverpool. As the P: and O: Co boats now come direct and arrive at Constantinople in about fifteen days, a letter will not take more than a month to come here and the same to go home.

I see a long story in the newspapers about disturbances in Persia, the greater part of which are untrue, and also a most horrible account of the ravaging of the Nestorian country by Beder Khan Bey which has more truth in it.[110] I trust you have not been alarmed by the accounts of the cholera here, and that my letters have reached you regularly.

There has been a row in Tehran about a Frenchman, a friend of mine, having flogged his servant for theft to such a degree that he died. The people demanded the blood of the Frenchman in exchange for that of the man who was flogged to death, who was a Mahomedan. The thing is not settled yet and I suppose the Frenchman will have to pay. Altho' he is a queer fish, I can not think that he would have the barbarity to flog a man to death and he denies that the man was flogged by his orders, he says that his other servants did it to make the man confess. But he formerly belonged to the army serving in Algeria where they see and do very queer things. — The affair is not yet settled. —

Troops are marching for Khorasan where there have been some disturbances but nothing like so serious as stated in the papers. — I pity the poor soldiers having to march in such weather; ill clothed and fed — and I am thankful that I am not likely to have a journey this winter.

Tabreez, February 2, 1847

I have just received a note from Tehran which has pleased me, it informs me that some translations which I sent for the Hadji have been presented, and that he liked them much. I intend to send him some more by the next post and still don't dispair of getting my place here confirmed by the Shah, with an increase of pay of course, but this as I before explained all depends upon the Hadji.

Our new Consul, Mr Richard Stevens, has not yet arrived. When he comes Abbott will have to go to Tehran, and a most cold journey he will have until he gets more than half way, the winter in this upper country is most severe, the

[110] For a detailed account see Thomas Laurie, *Dr. Grant and the mountain Nestorians*, Boston, 1856, p. 323–365.

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